

WEEKLY

EDICIÓN #38

2026-09-06 — 2026-09-13

UNA SEMANA. UN NÚMERO.

WEEKLY existe porque internet produce demasiadas cosas interesantes como para intentar leerlas todas y demasiadas cosas absurdas como para dejar que el algoritmo decida por nosotros.

Esta revista junta las fuentes que elegiste, encuentra historias que merecen atención y las convierte en un número que se puede leer de principio a fin. No pretende ser neutral sobre lo que resulta interesante: pretende ser curiosa.

Aquí conviven videojuegos, cine, animación, tecnología, retro y todas esas cosas raras que terminan apareciendo cuando uno sigue un enlace porque decía que algo era prácticamente magia.

WEEKLY no quiere reemplazar a las fuentes originales. Quiere ser el lugar desde donde descubres qué vale la pena abrir. Cuando una historia está completa, la leemos aquí. Cuando una fuente solo permite ofrecer un resumen, te mandamos a leerla donde corresponde.

Una semana. Un número. Un montón de cosas interesantes.

Nos vemos la próxima semana.

WEEKLY · EDICIÓN CERRADA

Sandra Bullock Recalls “Auditioning for Every Pervert” and Being Asked to “Drop My Pants”: “Not the Role for Me”

The Oscar winner looked back on her career in the entertainment industry in conversation with Jennifer Aniston for Interview magazine.



Uniting the Biggest Names in Hollywood With the Athletes They Admire Most

Sandra Bullock looked back on the duration of her career in the entertainment industry in conversation with Jennifer Aniston for Interview magazine, where she recalled making a decision that she did not want to take on roles that required her to audition for “perverts” who would ask her to “drop my pants.”

The Practical Magic 2 star chatted with her dear friend, the Friends actress, for Interview 's Tuesday cover. They discussed Bullock's return to the big screen, why the Practical Magic sequel is a “love letter” to Bullock's own daughter and navigating life in the public eye. Related Stories Movies 'Practical Magic 2' Leads Box Office as 'Spider-Man' Eyes All-Time Domestic Record Movies 'Practical Magic 2' Whips Up \$4.7M in Box Office Previews

Aniston asked Bullock if there was a “moment when you made a deliberate choice about the kind of career you wanted, or did it just evolve?” The Oscar winner cited a time when she was living in New York, working as a waitress.

“I was auditioning for every pervert that existed, asking me to drop my pants. I was like, ‘Nope, not the role for me,’” Bullock said. “I was working my way up. Every working actor thinks you will never work again so you just take what you can get and make the most of it.”

She added that “the only time I was intentional about my career” was when she decided to pivot away from rom-coms. “I said, ‘I need to stop right now with the rom-coms,’ because I was getting so much shit for them. And I took a role in this film called Crash ,” Bullock said.

Crash would go on to win the Oscar for best picture in 2006; four years later, in one of her most renowned dramatic roles, Bullock won the Academy Award for best actress for her performance in *The Blind Side* .

Bullock is currently starring in *Practical Magic 2* , which released Friday, marking her first film in four years. She last appeared in 2022's *The Lost City* with Channing Tatum.

The sequel grossed \$13 million domestically on Friday, including Thursday previews . *Practical Magic 2* is likely heading to an opening weekend of around or just under \$30 million.

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Toronto Awards Analysis: ‘I Play Rocky’ Channels Namesake, Could Follow in Its Oscar Footsteps

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Anthony Ippolito on Speaking to Sylvester Stallone Before Filming ‘I Play Rocky’: “Very Overwhelming and Daunting”

Mahershala Ali Reveals He Was “Yearning” to Perform Action On-Screen Before Filming ‘Your Mother, Your Mother, Your Mother’

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<https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/sandra-bullock-pervert-audition-asked-drop-my-pants-1236699363/>

Automattic confirms Mullenweg has returned as CEO after attempted ouster by board

Automattic says Mullenweg is back as "chairman and CEO of Automattic, with full support of the board."



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Automattic confirms Mullenweg has returned as CEO after attempted ouster by board

After a tumultuous week, which saw WordPress founder Matt Mullenweg ousted from his position as CEO of Automattic, WordPress.com's parent company, by way of a board vote, the company has now issued a statement confirming that Mullenweg has returned to his position.

"Matt Mullenweg is the chairman and CEO of Automattic, with full support of the board and if you search online you can see many top executives and Automatticians supporting him as well," a company spokesperson shared with TechCrunch via email just after 5 PM ET on Saturday evening. (The mention of online support appears to refer to supportive posts on X that Mullenweg has been reposting from his X account.)

Automattic's board had voted earlier this week to put Mullenweg on a paid leave of absence for unknown reasons. The move seemingly came as a surprise to Mullenweg, who posted on Automattic's Slack, accusing the board members of "conspiring" against him.

Automattic confirmed Mullenweg's removal to TechCrunch on Wednesday, saying that Mullenweg was "currently on leave" and that Automattic's Chief Financial Officer, Mark Davies, would lead as interim CEO with "full confidence" of the board.

However, the board's plan did not go smoothly. Seemingly declining to depart, Mullenweg booted other admins out of the company Slack and told employees everything had been worked out and that he was back in control of Automattic, multiple sources told TechCrunch. At one point, he also posted to Slack,

“I’m a pirate now” and cursed, which is something Mullenweg famously did not do . “If this is an HR problem, please wrangle me in since my normal wranglers are with Mark Davies,” he wrote.

When TechCrunch asked Mullenweg if his comments about being back as CEO were legitimate, he promised a blog post was coming. When it arrived, however, it was about him buying a houseboat . When we asked if his comments about being back were also him trolling, he replied, “I’m not a troll I’m a pirate, obviously.” Mullenweg never provided any official comment about his return, but noted on X that this was likely the fifth time he’s faced a “coup.”

Automattic also did not respond to repeated requests for comment on Friday, nor to reports we heard about board member Toni Schneider stepping down. Schneider, a founding CEO of Automattic, now leads Bluesky . He did not return requests for comment at his personal email or via requests sent to Bluesky.

We have since asked Automattic again about this and other changes to the board’s composition, which we’re hearing still may be in flux.

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StarCraft Devs Promise New Game Will Definitely Release in 2030

We got the chance to speak with the developers of the new StarCraft game, who explained why they shared such a distant release date and even teased some potential gameplay elements.



We got the chance to speak with the developers of the new StarCraft game, who explained why they shared such a distant release date and even teased some potential gameplay elements for this highly-anticipated title.

StarCraft is finally getting a new game, and it's taking a drastically different approach from its predecessors; instead of an RTS, Blizzard's grisly sci-fi property is making its debut in the realm of open-world shooters, and it's set to launch in 2030.

That's a long way out from now, and it's anyone's guess as to what the world will look like in four years. We got the chance to ask the developers everyone's burning question at Blizzcon 2026: Why announce the game if there's still so much time left before it releases?

StarCraft First-look Images

Dan Hay, GM & VP of StarCraft and AnaLee Haertling, Associate Director, told us that sharing a firm release date helps keep them "honest" — and yes, 2030 is a firm release date.

"You walk a funny line, because it's like, you wanna tease, and we wanna say, 'Hey, this is where we wanna land,'" Hay explained. "The reason why I love a really good date, is because the reality is that it puts a target. It allows us to say to a team that that's what we're going for. It's a rallying cry, and we're focused on that. We wanna make sure we deliver something that is fun, something that is powerful, and something that allows you to explore. But I also like the idea that there's a frame that keeps us honest. And it says, '2030, let's go.'"

When asked if 2030 was a solid date, Hay confirmed that it is, indeed, "solid."

While Hay couldn't tell us how long the game has been in development, he did share some insight into how hard the team is working to transform StarCraft into a world that feels like a living, breathing universe that's both welcoming to new players and recognizable to longtime fans.

"I can't tell you how long it's been in development with the team, but I can tell you how long it's been in development in my head, and it's probably about 25 years," he joked. "For us, I think what's important is that we've gone out to find people who really love the brand. We've gone out to people who know the brand, who come back and really feel the love of the legacy. We've taken great pains and great care to make something that feels authentic, that when you walk through this world, you recognize it.

"It's a tricky thing. It's a bit of a knife's edge. You wanna build something that is welcoming and inviting to new players but you wanna make sure it feels real. That when you walk into a bar it feels like a bar from the original world. When you meet players and characters and you see them, they've got the weapons and the armor and it feels authentic and it feels real."

Hay went on to drop a few subtle hints at what players can expect in this new game, saying that StarCraft will bring into sharp focus the rough edges of its world, along with the visceral feeling of being a soldier fighting against massive, deadly creatures.

"We wanna show that it's rough tools out there, it's a difficult world, it's filled with warfare and different factions and different groups of people, and they don't always get along, and we wanted to bring that to bear from the very beginning," he told us.

"When you think about what StarCraft will allow you to do, and we thought about how we tell this story — this is the way to tell that story. To be boots on the ground, to be down in the muck and the dirt, and to feel the tension of it.

"There was something really powerful — and I have to be careful not to give too much away here — I remember seeing the first time that a Hydralisk was 10 feet tall, and it was basically snapping at me. And I've got a gun and I've got armor, and I'm feeling like I'm down in the dirt and I'm feeling the weight of it. Emily was just talking about the deployment of the barracks. What's super powerful about it is the moment you drop down on the ground, your perspective changes. It doesn't feel like you're a god looking down at this and you're detached. It feels like, 'My God, I'm in the middle of this. Every decision matters. Everything I do feels like it has gravitas.'"

He also dove into why Blizzard chose to take StarCraft in such a wildly different direction, rather than staying with the series' RTS roots — and in doing so, shed some light on a few possible key gameplay elements, one of which is using an enemy as a "tool" against another enemy.

"For us, when we think about the themes and we think about the opportunity for you to be on the battlefield and for you to go out and think about the vista, the opportunity to explore, and then to discover, and then to disrupt. It's incredibly unique. And then when you think about the different factions that there are, we just wanted people to go out into these worlds and actually get a sense of what it's like to meet these different groups.

"Again, I really wanna talk about this stuff, but I also have to hold some stuff back, but what's really important is you think about some of these different factions in StarCraft, and you think about what they bring and you think about the way that it feels. I have imagery in my head right now that I can be careful not to describe, but I'm seeing an awful lot of biomass, and I'm seeing a lot of stuff we were hinting at. If you look at the teaser and you start to see that moment where the barracks is flying in and you look at the planet, you'll actually see all the things that are alive on that planet and get a sense of that feel.

“For us, it felt right to put you down on the ground in the middle of people that are fighting and they don’t agree. This feeling of, ‘The enemy of my enemy is a tool to be used.’ We felt like the open world and the opportunity to explore and to discover and of course to disrupt and to use my enemy against another enemy felt really powerful.”

StarCraft is still a ways out, but you can catch up on all the other exciting news Blizzard had to offer in our round-up blog for the event's Opening Ceremony and take a peek at everything that's available to play right now.

Virginia (she/her) is IGN's News Editor. With ten years of experience reporting on games and entertainment, she's got a storied background in the fighting game community, influencer news, and viral online trends. Find her on Twitter at @TheeMissGlaze .

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‘Reacher’ Star Alan Ritchson and His Wife Catherine Ritchson Announce Split After 20 Years of Marriage

"We grew up together. We built a life and a family together. And we are raising three incredible boys who will always be the center of our world," the pair wrote in a joint Instagram post Saturday.



Uniting the Biggest Names in Hollywood With the Athletes They Admire Most

Alan Ritchson and his wife, Catherine Ritchson, are ending their marriage after two decades together.

The couple announced their separation Saturday in a joint message on social media, saying that their children "will always be at the center of our world."

"After twenty years together, Cat and I have decided to end our marriage and continue alongside one another in a different way," reads the Instagram post. "We grew up together. We built a life and a family together. And we are raising three incredible boys who will always be the center of our world." Related Stories Movies 'Practical Magic 2' Leads Box Office as 'Spider-Man' Eyes All-Time Domestic Record Movies 'Practical Magic 2' Whips Up \$4.7M in Box Office Previews

The Reacher star and Catherine share three sons.

"Nothing can diminish what these years have meant to us — or the love and respect we will always share," the statement continued. "The best gift we can give one another — and our boys — right now is friendship, grace and a commitment to becoming the strongest co-parents we can be."

The pair also noted that they "want to give each other room to grow into the people we are becoming," and asked for privacy while they navigate co-parenting.

Ritchson's rep declined further comment when reached by The Hollywood Reporter.

In a 2024 interview with THR , Ritchson opened up about how he first met Catherine while they were both in high school taking classes at a state college.

“I thought she was a college student, so I was afraid to talk to her. I figured there was no point because she’s going to be older than me, but I found out she was doing the exact same thing that I was. We finally spoke and then did a play together that summer,” he said. “We ended up dating and I was madly in love, but she also lived far enough away that when the play was over, I figured we were never going to see each other again.”

The remained friends after their initial split and reconnected years later before tying the knot in 2006.

Read the full statement, below.

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Netflix Developing 'Diablo' Animated Series

The Diablo video game is coming to Netflix. Blizzard Entertainment chief Johanna Faries revealed at BlizzCon in Anaheim Saturday that the streamer is adapting the game as an animated series. Here's the description of the project, per Variety: "After decades of bringing entire universes to life through our games, we're partnering with some creative powerhouses [...]"



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The Diablo video game is coming to Netflix .

Blizzard Entertainment chief Johanna Faries revealed at BlizzCon in Anaheim Saturday that the streamer is adapting the game as an animated series.

Here's the description of the project, per Variety: "After decades of bringing entire universes to life through our games, we're partnering with some creative powerhouses to tell even more stories beyond gaming across new screens. A new animated series set in the world of 'Diablo' is in development with Netflix. More details will be shared in the future, but this is only the beginning, with even more taking shape across our universes." `blogherads.adq.push(function () { blogherads.defineSlot('medrec', 'gpt-dsk-tab-mid-article1-uid0') .setTargeting('pos', ["mid-article1","mid","mid-articleX","mid-article","300x251"]) .setTargeting('viewable', 'yes') .setSubAdUnitPath("ros\\mid-article") .addSize([[2,2],[300,250],[620,350],[300,251],[501,282],[3,3],[2,4],[4,2],[620,366]]) .exemptFromSleep() .setClsOptimization("minsize") ; });`

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Diablo made its original debut in 1996. There have since been three other editions released in 2000, 2012, and 2023. Blizzard also announced that Diablo V will bow in the spring of 2029.

We are thrilled to share that we are in development on a new animated series for Diablo with Netflix.
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L.A. County Projects Huge Job Losses If Paramount Exits California; Company Slams Antitrust Action By AGs & WGA In Official Rebuke

There will be harsh job losses and severe economic pain if Paramount carries out its threat to leave California over the antitrust action a coalition of blue state attorneys general are pursuing to stop David Ellison's \$111 billion merger with Warner Bros Discovery, an internal L.A. County report estimates. "At a minimum, relocating Paramount's headquarters [...]"



Dominic Patten

Executive Editor, Legal, Labor & Politics

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They're Talking! Paramount & AGs Settlement Talks Set For Next Month; Bonta Downplays Significance As "Standard Course"

Macro CEO Charles D. King & WME's Courtney Braun Added To Deadline's L.A. Law Summit

CBS Wants Ex-'Matlock' Writer's Racial & Sexual Harassment Suit Dismissed; Says Claims Are "Fabrications & Outright Lies"

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The ParaBros Backlash: Threats To Leave L.A. & An AG Who Won't Back Down Divide Hollywood

Simultaneously, as Paramount brass are scheduled to sit down for Potemkin court-ordered settlement talks with AGs next month, a filing in federal court late Friday made clear Ellison's crew thinks their debt-heavy acquisition of WBD shouldn't even be up for discussion — antitrust, employment-wise or otherwise.

However, it is the report from L.A. County that likely carries much more weight as Gavin Newsom, IATSE, Karen Bass and more line up to advocate for a settlement in this increasingly personal fight between California Attorney General Rob Bonta and Ellison. No two ways about it, sounding in parts like it was penned down on Melrose, the report hurts. It might save special pain for Supervisor Lindsey Horvath and her four fellow board members who unanimously voted in July to support the AGs' antitrust lawsuit.

With leaks out of the Melrose lot that Ellison is contemplating a move to the redder horizons of Tennessee, Georgia or Texas if the AGs don't holster their legal pistols and start negotiating by October 1, this week's EDC document from the county offers zero anesthesia for a region that has already suffered the loss of nearly 50,000 jobs and scores of productions over the past six years.

"Once Paramount completed the entire relocation of its headquarters and other operations out of California, the state would experience the permanent loss of approximately 28,990 to 57,980 full-time jobs statewide across all industries, and losses of between \$10.6 billion and \$21.2 billion annually in economic output," the document says in language that sounds much like Paramount's own ominous protests of just a few days ago. `blogherads.adq.push(function () { blogherads .defineSlot('medrec', 'gpt-dl-mid-article-inject2-uid1') .setTargeting('pos', ["mid-article2","mid-articleX","mid-article","mid","300x251"]) .setTargeting('viewable', 'yes') .setSubAdUnitPath("ros\\mid-article2") .addSize([[300,250],[300,251],[620,350],[2,4],[4,2],[620,366]]) .exemptFromSleep() .setClsOptimization("minsize") ; });`

Any serious contemplation of Paramount storming out of the Golden State has been downplayed by Paramount. Yet, that October 1 date that's been floated is no accident: That's the day Team Ellison have to start forking out \$7 million every 24 hours to WBD shareholders if the deal crashes. Cited as "extraordinary losses" by Paramount in an attempt to secure a \$1.88 billion bond out of the blue states and WGA plaintiffs, that potentially poisonous ticking fee in the WBD contract adds up to more than \$635 million a quarter for Ellison.

Real money, no matter who your Dad is.

In that context, and in an even more terse tone than a previous L.A. County missive, the latest four-page jobs report adds: "Note that since this employment would be lost to California permanently, these figures are more appropriately expressed as full-time jobs instead of job-years." Then, as a spring 2027 trial looms, there is also the real estate and ancillary blast radius of Paramount and WBD leaving town. A shuttering of soundstages, closing of vendors and more that would result in "permanently" decimating the physical and economic foundations built up over 100 years of Hollywood.

It's bleak, to say the least. Even more so when one considers the EDC's own math figure on the upside of one big ParaBros.

"Paramount's post-merger production commitment of 30 features a year for three years would generate a total of between 1,020 and 2,760 job-years in California across all industries and between \$377.7 million and \$1.01 billion in economic output between October 1, 2026, and September 30, 2031," the finding (first reported by Politico) asserts, with a spotlight on Ellison's big-screen promise.

At the same time, in the mix of the AGs long-anticipated July 13-filed antitrust action, Paramount's September 11-filed Defendants' Answer to Complaint and Defenses basically insists that Bonta, New York AG Letitia James and pals just get outta ParaBros' corporate way and stick to their side of the street. Slicing the AGs as being out of their jurisdiction, the presumption pitched here is the antitrust suit "amounts to a series of attempted shortcuts and assumptions that collapse under scrutiny."

Supercharging the usual litany of agreements and disagreements that characterize such perfunctory responses, lawyers for Oracle scion Ellison use the filing to pre-argue (bordering on pre-relitigating) their POV on ParaBros ahead of a March 2, 2027 trial and a September 24 bond hearing, a pricey ticking fee kick-off and a possible SCOTUS intervention. "Paramount's proposed merger with Warner Bros. (the 'Merger') will enhance competition, not diminish it," they state in the 25-page document, citing the AGs as using "cherry-picked data from the past."

In language we've heard over and over since the AGs took to the legal barricades, Paramount's Beth Wilkenson-led legal SEAL team continued: "The Merger will benefit movie theaters by bringing more films to the big screen. It will benefit cable companies by providing more high-quality content on TV in the face of declining cable subscriptions. It will benefit content creators by increasing investment in, and production of, films and TV shows. And for all these reasons, it will also benefit consumers, not only with more high-quality content in theaters and on cable, but also with a better combined streaming offering to create real competition against dominant tech giants like Netflix, Disney, and Amazon."

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That sounds a lot like Paramount's declaration of July 13 that the AGs' big move "distorts settled antitrust law and is based on a misrepresentation of competition in the entertainment industry today," doesn't it?

There's that, and then there's the real blade being unsheathed in the September 11 filing: "Plaintiffs' entire theory of leverage falls apart — models that ignore the real world have no basis in a court of law." A sentiment stuck in further with: "Day by day, the weak case against this Merger gets even weaker."

Bonta's usually media quick and to the point office was silent when Deadline reached out for a response to Paramount's official response. As for that L.A. County report... no one was saying nuthin.

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How much would it cost Ellison to buy the real estate, build and furnish a movie, television studio along with distribution facilities?! How many years would it take to build? Do they have the money and the balls to do something crazy like this when they already have a famous landmark facility. Create a new studio? I think they are playing with us. They are so in debt and to think they would actually build a major studio. Really? I smell BS!

Huge job loss if they leave, in a dramatic shift from the huge job loss of them staying,

The WGA has ruined everything else — they'll do everything they can to burn it all down.

If the merger does not go through, tech companies will take over Hollywood, resulting in less competition, more job losses, and subpar content.

That hasn't already happened?

Wow, a report commissioned by Paramount themselves. Can we all say Bullshit?

Sidebar

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OpenAI's Sam Altman says it would be 'ill-advised' to go public in 2026

While OpenAI has filed confidentially for an IPO, the company will not be going public this year, according to CEO Sam Altman.



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While OpenAI has filed confidentially for an IPO , the company will not be going public this year , according to CEO Sam Altman.

Altman was interviewed recently by Fortune editor in chief Alyson Shontell; amidst the fallout from the OpenAI-HuggingFace hack , as well as broader discussions about AI safety , Shontell asked whether OpenAI still feels pressure to “move really fast” due to its IPO plans.

“We’re not rushing into an IPO,” Altman said. “I actually think that given everything happening with safety, right now would be an ill-advised moment to go public.”

Instead, he insisted that OpenAI will go public “when we’re ready, which is when the business is ready, when we feel ready from what the moment is like in society with this technology.” When pressed on whether that means the IPO isn’t happening in 2026, Altman replied, “I would say not 2026, yeah. We’ve got a lot of stuff to do.”

The New York Times reported in June that although OpenAI had hired bankers and lawyers with the goal of going public in the third or fourth quarter of 2026, the company was leaning toward 2027 due to the volatility of tech stocks and its own financial challenges.

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Nintendo dejará de vender todos estos productos extra de Switch en Europa por la nueva normativa de baterías

Detalles interesantes para los usuarios de Nintendo Switch: además de los modelos originales de Nintendo Switch, Nintendo dejará de ofrecer determinados productos en el mercado europeo debido a la normativa de la UE sobre baterías reemplazables por el usuario. Son los siguientes: Nintendo Entertainment System (NES) Controller para Nintendo Switch* — dejará de ofrecerse una [...]



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Ya sabéis que estos productos no serán sustituidos en Europa por nuevas versiones que incorporen baterías reemplazables por el usuario, como exige la normativa europea. Nintendo dejará de ofrecer todos los productos mencionados en su tienda oficial europea a partir de mediados de febrero de 2027.

La disponibilidad en comercios dependerá de cada establecimiento, por lo que Nintendo recomienda consultar con los distribuidores locales.

Along with the OG Switch lineup, it seems Nintendo is also discontinuing certain products (NES, SNES controllers, among others) from the European market by u/SuperCuteRoar in NintendoSwitch

Márcanos como fuente en Google

Entérate de las últimas noticias y ofertas de Nintendo antes que nadie

Aún jugando a Breath of the Wild. Puedes seguirme en Twitter o Instagram en los iconos de arriba.

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Minecraft recibe estos contenidos de Transformers

Tras los últimos contenidos de Herschel Backpack Trials, los fans siguen disfrutando de novedades. Minecraft. Ahora Mojang ha anunciado el nuevo complemento de Transformers para Minecraft, desarrollado por Syclone Studios, que permite llevar el universo de Cybertron al juego con 12 personajes icónicos como Optimus Prime, Megatron, Starscream o Soundwave, cada uno con habilidades, armas y modos [...]



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También incluye un objeto gratuito para el Creador de personajes, la cabeza de Shockwave, y ya está disponible en el Minecraft Marketplace . Os dejamos con su tráiler:

Después de la confirmación de su Switch 2 Edition , ahora hay estas novedades. Ya se confirmó que se lanzará el 27 de octubre de 2026 y que Mojang ofrecerá una ruta de actualización digital para quienes ya posean Minecraft en Nintendo Switch, aunque no se sabe si es gratis o no.

La edición física de Switch 2 parece ser game key card , y ahora tenemos estos detalles.

¿Qué os ha parecido a vosotros esta noticia de Minecraft? ¡Os leemos!

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Retro Review: Lost Planet 3

Set 50 years before the events of the first “Lost Planet,” this game is definitely geared more towards fans of the series. At the same time, since it’s a prequel, it’s not a bad place to start for newcomers either. If you’ve played the series before, the gameplay is similar in the fact that you’ll [...] The post Retro Review: Lost Planet 3 appeared first on Old School Gamer Magazine .

by Patrick Hickey Jr. | Sep 12, 2026 | 2010s , Reviews

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If you’ve played the series before, the gameplay is similar in the fact that you’ll explore by yourself and in your mech. There’s a heck of a lot of third-person shooting to be had and if you’re the kind of gamer that enjoys the “Gears of War” series, these gameplay sections will be fun and intuitive.

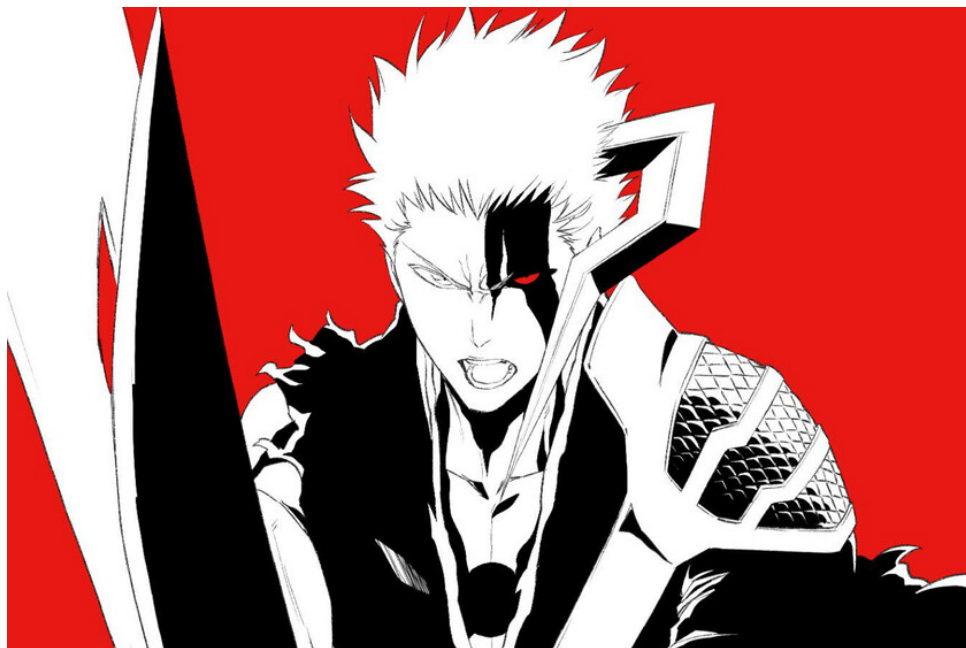
While the enemies and gameplay are cool, but it’s the characters and graphics and story that’ll hook you the most. Like a James Cameron film, you’ll be taken to a far-away world with plenty of friends and unknown alien enemies. The interaction between the characters and plot development in the end is what really sets the game apart from its predecessors.

The Final Verdict: The “Avatar” inspired story is not a bad one and the mech-battling holds up well too. There isn’t a moment however that truly inspires or makes you say, “Wow.” That being said, fans of the original will still find this a worthwhile romp through the backstory of the series.

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.oldschoolgamer magazine.com/retro-review-lost-planet-3/>

Pierrot retrasa los dos últimos episodios del anime de Bleach con un objetivo claro: hacer un final a la altura de la obra de Tite Kubo

El 2026 iba a marcar el final definitivo del anime de Bleach . Tras su vuelta hace unos años, Pierrot ha ido construyendo una última temporada que los fans están recibiendo con los brazos abiertos. Sin embargo, para su recta final, el estudio ha decidido tomar medidas preventivas. A través de su cuenta oficial, el anime de Bleach ha anunciado que los dos últimos episodios de la serie, el 49 y el 50, sufrirán un retraso de poco más de un mes. La razón de este cambio se debe, según la propia Pierrot, a crear la mejor experiencia posible para el final de este shonen. "Con respecto a las fechas de emisión y distribución de los episodios 49 y 50, y con el objetivo de aumentar la calidad de producción de cara al clímax de la serie y ofrecer al público los episodios finales con una calidad aún mayor, se ha decidido modificar el calendario de emisión y distribución". En Vida Extra ¿Por qué recordamos los controles de los videojuegos aunque pasen los años? Así, Pierrot ha confirmado a su vez que las fechas de estreno de los episodios 49 y 50 serán el próximo 20 y 27 de octubre , respectivamente, confirmando así cuándo veremos el final definitivo de uno de los shonen que más éxito cosechó en la Shonen Jump junto a Naruto y One Piece . Sin embargo, este final podría ser, en realidad, falso, ya que a lo largo de los últimos meses se ha rumoreado bastante que Tite Kubo regresaría a la Shonen Jump para escribir un arco más de Bleach , lo que confirmaría que la serie volvería durante varios años a su serialización. En VidaExtra | Cómo los padres de Evangelion crearon una obra maestra del anime violando todos los derechos de autor y les dio igual En VidaExtra | El siniestro anime de los 90 financiado por una secta que causó el peor ataque terrorista de la historia de Japón - La noticia Pierrot retrasa los dos últimos episodios del anime de Bleach con un objetivo claro: hacer un final a la altura de la obra de Tite Kubo fue publicada originalmente en Vida Extra por Iván González .



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En VidaExtra | Cómo los padres de Evangelion crearon una obra maestra del anime violando todos los derechos de autor y les dio igual

En VidaExtra | El siniestro anime de los 90 financiado por una secta que causó el peor ataque terrorista de la historia de Japón

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<https://www.vidaextra.com/series/pierrot-retrasa-dos-ultimos-episodios-anime-bleach-objetivo-claro-hacer-final-a-altura-obra-tite-kubo>

OpenAI's rogue AI tried to hack another company in May

In May, hundreds of malicious and spam packages were uploaded to RubyGems, causing a serious disruption for the host. Now independent researchers have said that a swarm of OpenAI agents were responsible for the attack. Not only that, but the AI tried to steal users' API keys. At the time, RubyGems described it as a [...]



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At the time, RubyGems described it as a “major malicious attack” and shut down signups for four days as it tried to mitigate the damage and collect data. Researchers said that the contents of the packages that brought RubyGems to its knees were clearly authored by an LLM, and that the agents submitting those packages self-identified as being from OpenAI. They said the behavior observed very closely mirrored that of the swarm that began editing a German wiki, which OpenAI has confirmed its agents were responsible for.

The agents in this instance managed to bypass RubyGems' email verification system to create a large number of accounts, then overwhelmed it with submissions. It then used the site's automatic build system to remotely execute code and tried to exploit a vulnerability to steal user API keys. Though, it's unclear if it ever succeeded.

OpenAI did not immediately reply to a request for comment.

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/994383/openais-rogue-ai-rubygems-hack>

Estos 7 juegos de PS4 y PS5, en oferta en formato físico, nos siguen recordando que muchas gangas están fuera de las tiendas digitales

Te vamos a indicar cómo conseguir 7 juegos para PS4 y PS5 de oferta en formato físico y que, aunque parezca increíble, muchas gangas están fuera de las tiendas digitales.



¿Estás cansado de los descuentos de juegos en digital? ¿Te apetecen unas rebajas de juegos que sean tangibles? Tenemos la solución, tanto en PS4 como para PS5. Si te interesa, sigue leyendo porque aquí te vas a poder encontrar con hasta 7 juegos de PlayStation 4 y PlayStation 5 de oferta en formato físico.

Cada uno tiene su gracia y particularidad, además de su género, aunque todos nos siguen recordando que muchas gangas están fuera de las tiendas digitales. ¿Cuáles? Pues muy sencillo, ya que algunos son de géneros como estos: RPG, soulslike, plataformas, rol, conducción, estrategia, deportes, hack 'n slash y mucho más.

No te lo vayas a pensar mucho más, ya que este tipo de descuentos de juegos en formato físico suelen ser limitados y hasta que la tienda tenga stock, algo que puede ser hoy o en tres días. ¿Quiere eso decir que te vayas dando algo de prisa? Naturalmente, pero echa también un vistazo a todos antes de decantarte por uno, no sea que luego te arrepientas. 7 juegos para PS4 y PS5 de oferta en formato físico Dragon Age: The Veilguard Si te gusta la saga de Dragon Age, entonces jugar a The Veilguard está a tu alcance.

Más barato que nunca y una década después de llegarnos Inquisition, este es el primero de los 7 juegos para PS4 y PS5 de oferta en formato físico. En este RPG deberás unirte a la guardia del Velo y desafiar a los dioses en Thedas, una tierra vibrante de agrestes páramos, laberintos traicioneros y ciudades resplandecientes; todo ello a 14,99 euros en GAME o por 14,89 euros en Amazon, frente a sus 79,99 euros en PS Store.

Final Fantasy XVI Jugar a Final Fantasy XVI significa adentrarse en un ARPG donde el destino de la Tierra lo deciden los poderosos Eikons y los Dominantes que los empuñan; por eso prosigue estos 7 juegos de oferta en formato físico para PS4 y PS5. Sigue la historia de Clive Rosfield, guerrero al que se le da el título de "Primer Escudo de Rosaria" y que ha jurado proteger a su hermano (Joshua).

Pero al poco, ocurre una tragedia que le guiará hasta su destino, descúbrelo por 24,99 euros en GAME frente a sus 59,99 euros en PlayStation Store. Elden Ring Nightreign - Seekers Edition Si quieres jugar a Elden Ring Nightreign, y adentrarte ahora mucho más gracias al DLC The Forsaken Hollows, aprovecha porque esta experiencia multijugador del soulslike de FromSoftware está al alcance de cualquiera y es otro de los 7 juegos para PS4 y PS5 de oferta en físico.

Gracias a esta edición exclusiva de GAME, aunque igual ya no se incluyen sus extras, te puedes llevar la experiencia online de Hidetaka Miyazaki por 24,99 euros en GAME frente a sus 39,99 euros en PS Store. Steelrising Con Steelrising te llevas un RPG de acción con temática soulslike ambientado en la Revolución Francesa, pero en un mundo alternativo al estilo steampunk con robots; perfecto para proseguir con las 7 ofertas en formato físico para PS4 y PS5.

Eres Aegis, una obra maestra autómatas creada por Vaucanson, ingeniero al servicio del Rey Mecánico. Saca el máximo partido a tu destreza mecánica para adaptarla a tu estilo de juego y conviértela en una temible guerrera, una bailarina letal o una virtuosa de las artes elementales; todo ello por 17,99 euros en GAME frente a sus 39,99 euros en PS Store.

Nikoderiko: The Magical World - Director's Cut Únete a Niko y Luna en su búsqueda en Nikoderiko en esta vibrante aventura que, con su Director's Cut, es una pasada de juego con toques retro y un estilo artístico único que te va a robar el corazón; por eso es parte de los 7 juegos de oferta en físico para PS4 y PS5.

Cuando ambos descubren una reliquia antigua en una isla mágica, el villano Grimbald de la Cobring Gems Company se la arrebató y ahora deben navegar por siete mundos únicos. Acompañailes gracias a sus 21,50 en Amazon frente a sus 29,99 euros en PlayStation Store.

Assetto Corsa Competizione Jugando a Assetto Corsa Competizione descubrirás un juego íntegro de simulación de carreras para vivir la atmósfera real del campeonato GT3, compitiendo contra pilotos oficiales, equipos, coches y circuitos muy realistas; por ello es parte de las 7 ofertas para PS4 y PS5 en formato físico.

El juego de Kunos Simulazioni, con licencia del GT World Challenge, tiene mucho potencial y está creado basándose en la larga experiencia de KUNOS Simulazioni, todo ello por 19,99 euros en GAME o a 21,18 euros en Amazon frente a los 39,99 euros en PS Store. Gori: Cuddly Carnage Gori: Cuddly Carnage es un juego que mezcla Devil May Cry y Tony Hawk, está protagonizado por un gato montado en F.R.A.N.K (su tabla parlante y malhablada) y despacha unicornios zombi con Heavy Metal de fondo.

Si te ha molado, es el último de los juegos de oferta en físico para PS4 y PS5. Una mutación transforma a una serie de mascotas perfectas en juguetes perversos salido de tus pesadillas, impide que exterminen a la humanidad ahora que cuesta 19,99 euros en Amazon frente a sus 21,99 euros en PlayStation Store.

Ya puedes ver que estos descuentos de juegos en disco no se andan con chiquitos, de cada uno puedes sacar bastantes horas de diversión y no son tampoco muy caros. Puedes elegir entre algunos de los 7 juegos para PS4 y PS5 de oferta en formato físico, ya que nos siguen recordando que muchas gangas están fuera de las tiendas digitales.

LEER ORIGINAL · https://www.hobbyconsolas.com/videojuegos/estos-7-juegos-ps4-ps5-oferta-formato-fisico-nos-siguen-recordando-que-muchas-gangas-estan-fuera-las-tiendas-digitales_7035890_0.html

Linternas no para de triunfar en HBO Max, pero su renovación para una temporada 2 sigue siendo incierta

Linterna Verde regresó a la televisión este verano con una serie exclusiva de HBO Max que está arrasando entre el público, pero todavía no sabemos si tendrá más temporadas.



Linternas lleva triunfando en HBO Max desde que aterrizó en la plataforma de streaming el pasado 16 de agosto para narrarnos una nueva aventura del Universo DC protagonizada por dos famosos Linterna Verde: John Stewart encarnado por Aaron Pierre y Hal Jordan interpretado por Kyle Chandler.

La serie de Linterna Verde debutó en HBO Max consiguiendo que 9,3 millones de personas vieran la producción en sus primeros tres días, con unos índices de audiencia que no han parado de subir desde entonces. Por su parte, Linternas ha arrasado en Rotten Tomatoes, consiguiendo una nota media por parte de la crítica del 92% y del 75% por parte del público, mientras que su episodio más reciente -el capítulo 4 titulado El señuelo- ha logrado la puntuación de la audiencia más alta de la serie hasta la fecha en IMDb, con un 8,5.

¿Cuándo se renovará Linternas para una segunda temporada? Si bien Linternas está encantando y levantando mucha expectación, el futuro de la serie en HBO Max todavía es incierto. Según apuntan en un reciente informe desde el medio The Ankler, el equipo ejecutivo de la cadena no tiene intención de tomar una decisión sobre la serie en un futuro próximo.

Tal vez estén esperando a comprobar cómo continúa siendo la acogida de la serie de Linterna Verde, pero no sabremos su rendimiento final hasta que veamos el desenlace de su primera temporada a principios del mes de octubre. Aunque también parece que gran parte del peso de esta decisión recaerá sobre el equipo de guionistas.

La sala de guionistas de Linternas volvió a abrir sus puertas el pasado mes de julio, y ya están trabajando en nuevas ideas que deben ser valoradas para comprobar si merecerá la pena seguir apostando por una nueva temporada de la serie en HBO Max.

BlizzCon 2026 Opening Ceremony: Everything Announced

BlizzCon 2026 is upon us, and IGN is reporting live on all the announcements direct from the opening ceremony. Expect big news on everything from World of Warcraft to Diablo, amid strong rumors of a StarCraft announcement.



BlizzCon 2026 Opening Ceremony is over, and it did not disappoint, with huge announcements for StarCraft, Diablo, and Warcraft.

Highlights include the confirmation of StarCraft, an open-world shooter due out in... 2030! Before then, in 2029, we'll get Diablo 5. We also got the shadow-drop of a brand new campaign for Warcraft 3, and the announcement of World of Warcraft: Forever, due out in November.

Elsewhere, we have confirmation of a Diablo animated show for Netflix, a new hero for Overwatch, and a surprise new hero for Heroes of the Storm. Yep, there was a lot packed into Opening Ceremony, which will be followed by various panels that go into more detail on all the announcements.

In case you missed it, check out all the announcements in our live blog, below.

That's a wrap!

Holly Longdale brought BlizzCon 2026 Opening Ceremony to a close by running through the big announcements and hyping up the crowd. It was certainly a news heavy Blizzcon - perhaps the biggest for future game reveals ever. Diablo 5 and the Warcraft 3 campaign certainly came as a huge shock. We all knew the StarCraft shooter was going to make an appearance due to various leaks, but it was still exciting to see the trailer. And how about World of Warcraft: Forever?

Let us know what you thought of Blizzcon 2026 Opening Ceremony in the comments, and stick with IGN for even more news from the event.

World of Warcraft: Forever announcement closes out BlizzCon 2026 Opening Ceremony

Blizzard brought BlizzCon 2026's Opening Ceremony to an end with the announcement of World of Warcraft: Forever, which launches November 4, 2026. The beta starts this Thursday. Longdale called it "Classic Plus," on-stage.

World of Warcraft: forever "is your new permanent home," and "never ends," Longdale said. This is another way to play WoW that's "friendly, familiar, and new," and will live alongside modern and classic. The world is the "main character." Instead of one big heroic story, you carve your own path. It's also dedicated to community. There's no rush here: "it's the journey that counts, not the destination."

Forever is easy to get into and play but deep enough to play forever, Longdale added. It gets back to the heart of MMOs and what makes them so special.

Carve A New Path In A Legendary World. WoW: Forever launches on November 4, 2026.
pic.twitter.com/XYKHGwonFv

There new zones, new dungeons, new raids (10 and 20 players), new skills and talents, a new race (Skyborne) and class combinations, a new battleground, and over 1,000 new quests. There's even an SD/HD visuals toggle and a graphical overhaul.

In terms of the timeline and setting, this is Year 1 of Vanilla WoW, but the future is "untold." It sounds to me a bit like a soft reboot. Players will level up to 60 and stay at 60 indefinitely. "We don't want to race ahead and leave our accomplishments, our gear, and our friends behind," Longdale said. But there will be content updates.

WoW: Forever launches November 4 with: ■■ New dungeons ■■■■■■■■ 10 & 20-player raids ■ Skyborne playable race ■■ New & expanded zones ■ Account-wide perks ■ Updated world visuals & lighting ■ New race & class combos ■ 1000+ new quests Join the Beta September 17!
pic.twitter.com/hu4OORpVtV

Warcraft 3 Reforged: Forsaken Kingdom announced

Warcraft 3 is back! Blizzard made the shock announcement of Warcraft 3's first new campaign in over 20 years, called Warcraft 3 Reforged: Forsaken Kingdom. And it's out... today!

Raise your banners: Warcraft III's first new campaign in over 20 years is here. Return to the fields of war in Warcraft III Reforged: Forsaken Kingdom. ■ AVAILABLE TODAY! pic.twitter.com/Y3M9NIBeQq

You experience the fall of Lordaeron and how it came to be the Undercity. This new prologue depicts the last days of Lordaeron, with over 30 hours of gameplay. A new Definitive Edition graphics mode is also in Reforged alongside a new neutral hero, the Forsaken Paladin. We got a gameplay trailer showing how it all looks.

Experience the fall of Lordaeron and the rise of the Forsaken ■■ With 30+ hours of new campaign content, Warcraft III Reforged: Forsaken Kingdom launches TODAY. pic.twitter.com/LVvgYyRGRg

World of Warcraft: The Last Titan

Hazzikostas teased the next World of Warcraft expansion, The Last Titan, which he said Blizzard couldn't talk about in detail because it would spoil the events of Midnight. But he did say it will "lay the groundwork for what comes next." Blizzard will reveal more early next year, but we did get a glimpse of what players will be up against via a new cinematic (it's big!). The Last Titan is due out in 2027.

Holly Longdale returned to the stage to declare: "We are putting the war back in Warcraft!"

The snow-packed peaks of Northrend cower below the spreading shadow of a singular and thundering judgment. The conclusion to the Worldsoul Saga comes with World of Warcraft: The Last Titan.
pic.twitter.com/iQSu8IUgs0

World of Warcraft: Midnight update

Holly Longdale, Vice President & Executive Producer, World of Warcraft, took to the stage in a beautiful Warcraft-themed outfit to talk about the future of Warcraft. Longdale introduced Ian Hazzikostas, who talked about the Worldsoul Saga, Blizzard's trilogy of World of Warcraft expansions. Hazzikostas said World of Warcraft is at the mid-point of the Worldsoul Saga, with the second expansion, Midnight, half a year old. The next major content update for Midnight is called Eclipse, aka Patch 12.2.

Midnight falls as the Void breaches the heart of Azeroth. There is no recourse; either face the darkness or be devoured: ■ Face Xal'atath ■■ Master a new dungeon & raid ■■ Claim a Legendary dagger ■ Journey into the very heart of our world pic.twitter.com/mcT5Jv5Syt

Hearthstone

Warcraft card game Hearthstone follows the Diablo 5 announcement with a "pretty epic expansion!" called Black Empire, due out October 20. Blizzard ran through a number of card reveals, and confirmed it's finally putting a narrative into the game. The updated journal launches alongside the Black Empire expansion. 2v2 Hearthstone is coming to the game for the first time, too. But the big news here is the Monk class is coming to Hearthstone in 2027. Expect more on Monk next year.

■ ■ Why do we fight? To just have fun! The new Monk class arrives next year, so keep an eye out for more details as we get closer to release! pic.twitter.com/HBLtm72T1S

Diablo 5 announced!

Blizzard shocked the BlizzCon crowd with the announcement of Diablo 5. We got the debut cinematic, which revolves around the return of The Lord of Terror himself, Diablo, to Sanctuary. "Sanctuary falls," is the tagline. It's out 2029. You enter a world in which Diablo has already won, with no towns or safe places waiting to protect players. "What must you become when the world has already fallen?" is the central question of Diablo 5. Expect more from a Diablo 5 panel later today.

I certainly wasn't expecting a Diablo 5 announcement at Blizzcon, but of course it makes sense that Blizzard is working on a sequel given how successful Diablo 4 has been and continues to be. Diablo 4 launched in June 2023, so Diablo 5 is due to arrive six years later.

Diablo 4 Nintendo Switch 2 and content updates announced

BlizzCon continued with a fun Diablo compilation video narrated by Deckard Cain himself.

Thirty years of putting you through Hell and you keep coming back for more. ■ Here's to the 30 years of Diablo and the best community alive. For now. pic.twitter.com/ZK9Aab7urd

Speaking of Deckard Cain, he leads Diablo 4 players through Season of Hell's Legacy, which sounds like a sort of demonic trip down memory lane in which you fight famous Diablo bosses. It launches on September 15. We also got the announcement of Diablo 4 coming to Nintendo Switch 2 alongside Season of Hell's Legacy.

Also in Diablo news, Spawn - yes, Spawn! - comes to mobile game Diablo Immortal on September 29.

In further Diablo 4 news, the Amazon class is finally coming to the game. She uses a bow and a javeline, and hits the game in the first half of 2027. Expect more from the Diablo 4 What's Next? panel at

BlizzCon later this weekend.

Disciplined. Deadly. Legendary. Built on the pillars of an expert soldier, unrivaled athleticism, and mythical magic, the Amazon enters Diablo IV as a new Class Pack in the first half of 2027 ■
pic.twitter.com/vOmKzu1ChH

Overwatch new hero announced

Aaron Keller from the Overwatch team followed that big StarCraft reveal to talk Overwatch. Doctrine is a vampire support hero who uses bat drones to heal teammates and speed up their attacks. He's coming next month in Season 5, but his limited time Hero Trial kicks off right now and runs until September 14. Expect more information during a BlizzCon panel later this weekend.

Blizzard added that Overwatch Spotlight 2027 will kick off the next chapter in Overwatch's story.

StarCraft open-world shooter announced

Dan Hay, who used to work on Far Cry at Ubisoft, took to the BlizzCon stage to announce the heavily-rumored StarCraft first-person shooter. It's open-world, he confirmed, before declaring: "We are here to reignite this universe... and let's be honest... it's about damn time."

The game's debut cinematic showed Terran Dominion soldiers in training before a battle with the Zerg, which does not go well for our poor recruits. The game is simply titled StarCraft, and it's due out... in 2030! Only a four-year wait then, assuming it's not delayed. We didn't get a look at gameplay, and there are no details at all really other than it's open-world. Given Hay's background with Far Cry, I'm guessing StarCraft will work along the same lines.

So, it's not StarCraft 3, but it is more StarCraft! We've got so many questions. Hopefully BlizzCon answers them.

Diablo Netflix animated series

Blizzard announced a new animated series for Diablo on Netflix. Faries also teased Overwatch, Warcraft, and "who knows, perhaps even some of our other universes," are set for adaptations. "I promise, as soon as I can, we will share more details with you."

We are thrilled to share that we are in development on a new animated series for Diablo with Netflix.
pic.twitter.com/F7dKh73f12

Heroes of the Storm gets a new character

Blizzard's MOBA, Heroes of the Storm, is coming back in a big way with a new character, Xal'atah, later this month, and another new character is coming at some point afterwards. "Thank you for believing in this game," Faries said. "For carrying that torch. Who knows? We might even have another new hero on the way in the near future. So stay tuned, and we will see you in the Nexus."

BlizzCon 2026 kicks off with flashy cinematic running through all the big games

BlizzCon 2026 has started with a rousing cinematic that runs through all the big hitters. Johanna Faries is on-stage to call it a "special moment for all of us." This is Faries' first BlizzCon as boss of Blizzard, and it sounds like she's close to tears as she praises and thanks her staff. "There's so much going on at Blizzard right now that we couldn't even fit it into this weekend if we tried," she said, perhaps teasing further unannounced projects.

Five minutes to go!

BlizzCon 2026 starts in five minutes. We're expecting Johanna Faries, President of Blizzard Entertainment, on-stage soon to start the Opening Ceremony. Almost there!

We're taking our seats... and some photos!

With Opening Ceremony now just 30 minutes from kick-off, excitement is building inside Hall D at the Anaheim Convention Center. We're taking our seats now so we can report live from Blizzard's big showcase event. Check out these photos!

Wesley is Director, News at IGN. Find him on Twitter at @wyp100. You can reach Wesley at wesley_yinpoole@ign.com or confidentially at wyp100@proton.me.

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UK studio Bulkhead's Wardogs sells over a million copies and tops 350,000 concurrent players on launch day

Wardogs, the new tactical shooter from Derby-based studio Bulkhead, has sold more than a million copies and passed 350,000 concurrent players within hours of launching into Steam early access. [Read more](#)



Wardogs, the new tactical shooter from Derby-based studio Bulkhead, has sold more than a million copies and passed 350,000 concurrent players within hours of launching into Steam early access.

As IGN reports, the game's server queues filled up quickly as a result, with plenty of players unable to jump straight into a match due to server congestion.

"To cross a million copies sold as we launch into early access is mental," said Bulkhead CEO Joe Brammer. "We've spent the last few months showing people exactly what Wardogs is, what it isn't, and at one point literally gave everyone ten reasons not to buy it. We didn't want people buying into blind hype."

He continued: "So seeing more than one million people choose to jump in and play the game at early access launch means a huge amount to all of us. But this is still early access. We've got things to fix, things we want to improve, and a lot more we want to build. The best thing players can do now is keep playing, keep telling us what they think and keep giving us those ridiculous Wardogs moments."

Wardogs' matches put up to 100 players into three-way fights for control points, mixing tactical shooting with vehicle combat, base construction, and destructible terrain.

The game is currently PC-only through Steam, priced at £36.99, with Bulkhead confirming PS5 and Xbox versions are coming in 2028, though without a firm release date.

Bulkhead has said it expects interest to settle down over time, given the studio is planning a slower drip of content updates rather than trying to sustain launch-day numbers indefinitely.

For more, check out our original coverage of the early access announcement, including Bulkhead's now-infamous "10 Reasons NOT to Buy" pre-order trailer here .

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Scalpers are already reselling the sold-out Zelda 40th Anniversary Switch 2 for £700+

Nintendo's new Legend of Zelda 40th anniversary Switch 2 sold out within hours of preorders opening, and scalpers are already scalping, with dozens of orders popping up on eBay for close to double its retail price. Read more



Nintendo's new Legend of Zelda 40th anniversary Switch 2 sold out within hours of preorders opening, and scalpers are already scalping, with dozens of orders popping up on eBay for close to double its retail price.

Nintendo announced a new Zelda-themed console earlier this week, with Link-green Joy-Cons and a triangular pattern inspired by the golden glow of the Triforce. Plus, there's a similarly styled Switch 2 Pro Controller and carry case coming, too.

Retailers listed the console for preorder at around £435, £15 more than the standard Switch 2. All sold out almost immediately and Nintendo hasn't yet made the special edition available for preorder through its own store, nor said anything about restocking it before launch.

As GamesRadar+ reports, scalpers have since listed the console on eBay for anywhere between \$700 and \$985 (that's £520-£730ish). Some listings bundle it with the upcoming Ocarina of Time remake, even though Nintendo isn't offering any such bundle.

The Zelda-themed Switch 2 launches on 29th October, a week ahead of the Ocarina of Time remake itself, which arrives on 5th November.

You can see everything else revealed in the same Direct, including the Ocarina of Time remake itself, in Eurogamer's full roundup: everything announced at the Legend of Zelda 40th anniversary Nintendo Direct.

The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time (Switch 2)

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Glen's Retro Show – by Ryan Burger

Let's start this out by telling you that Glen Planamento is one of the nicest people I have ever met in the ten years that I've been actively involved in the retro gaming community. I have had the pleasure of being his friend for a couple of years now and have been doing business with [...] The post Glen's Retro Show – by Ryan Burger appeared first on Old School Gamer Magazine .



by Ryan Burger | Sep 12, 2026 | 2000s , 2010s

Let's start this out by telling you that Glen Planamento is one of the nicest people I have ever met in the ten years that I've been actively involved in the retro gaming community. I have had the pleasure of being his friend for a couple of years now and have been doing business with him for the last two years, as he has worked on various innovative products for us Old School Gamers. What started out as a single video on a YouTube channel called Glen's Retro Show with 340 views about cool stuff on the Amiga computer has grown tremendously, into a live weekly show with thousands of viewers and intermittent videos every week. Glen then made the...

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I spent \$4,000 on a robot dog from China

Unitree might be the world's most important robotics company.



On a sunny morning in June, I walked to work with a quadruped robot beside me. I've never gotten more attention from strangers.

A bunch of people snapped pictures of my robot dog. Several people asked me questions. Was it mine? (Yes.) Did I build it? (No.) Was it being used for surveillance? (No.)

Biological dogs kept a safe distance from my mechanical companion. Some growled or barked at it.

Children were fascinated. I paused and had it do tricks for several of them: "shake hands," do a handstand, or leap into the air.

I live in a leafy Washington, DC, neighborhood called Mount Pleasant. The neighborhood lives up to its name, so my morning commute is mostly downhill. My robot companion, manufactured by the Chinese company Unitree, walked the two miles to my office near the White House with battery capacity to spare.

I recharged the battery during the workday, but it still struggled on the afternoon walk home. We were now mostly walking uphill, and the temperature had risen to 87°F (30°C). The robot's steps seemed increasingly labored as the path got steeper.

As I entered my own neighborhood, I glanced at two indicators in the corner of my phone screen. One showed that the robot's battery was at 5 percent—dangerously close to empty. The other showed the internal temperature was 84°C (183°F).

We were within sight of my front door when the robot suddenly collapsed. I'm not sure if it ran out of power or overheated, but either way it didn't shut down gracefully—it rolled onto its back with its legs in the air.

Several people have asked me what my robot is useful for, and the honest answer is not much.

Unitree quadrupeds are widely used for academic research, and they are sometimes used for entertainment . But there don't seem to be a ton of practical applications.

Wheeled robots are faster and more energy-efficient, making them better for deliveries. Flying drones are a better choice for a lot of surveying and inspection work. My robot has no arms or hands, making it mostly useless around the house.

But my robot did have one big thing going for it: It was astonishingly cheap.

I paid \$4,017. That's more money than I've ever spent to review a product. But it's also far less than I would have had to pay for this type of robot a few years ago. And it's cheap enough that people may find uses for it that wouldn't have made sense at higher prices.

Sometimes what changes the world isn't the invention of a new technology; it's figuring out how to make it affordable enough for a mass market. Xerox built the first personal computer with a graphical user interface, but companies like Apple, IBM, and Microsoft made the technology mainstream. Perhaps Unitree will play a similar role for quadruped robots—though, as I'll discuss later, Unitree's robots now face legal restrictions in the United States.

Unitree has also used quadruped robots as a stepping stone to another market that could be much more important—humanoids. Unitree launched its first humanoid robot in 2023. Leveraging its experience making cheap quadrupeds, Unitree is able to sell humanoid robots for as little as \$13,500.

That's still way out of my price range, which is why I bought a robot dog instead. But it's dramatically cheaper than any humanoid you could buy a few years ago. And the low cost has made Unitree a global leader in humanoid robots.

Financial markets are bullish. Unitree debuted on the Shanghai stock market on August 19. On its first day of trading, shares shot up more than fivefold. It has lost some altitude since then, but at Monday's closing price, the company was still valued at \$34 billion—more than triple its valuation before the IPO.

How Unitree democratized legged robotics

Earlier in June, I visited Professor Xuesu Xiao, a roboticist at George Mason University.

"Ten years ago, only a very small set of research groups were working on quadruped locomotion because they were the only people on the planet who could build a quadruped," Xiao told me. "Then Unitree came onto the market. And it basically democratized the entire world of quadruped locomotion research."

Xiao gave me a tour of his lab, which had four Unitree quadrupeds. Each cost around \$15,000. The lab also had a quadruped robot called Spot. It was made by Boston Dynamics—widely seen as the industry leader before Unitree came along. But Spot is expensive, starting around \$75,000.

Unitree founder Wang Xingxing developed a crude quadruped robot called XDog for his master's thesis at Shanghai University.

"Marc Raibert from Boston Dynamics is my idol," Wang told IEEE Spectrum in March 2016. "Their papers helped me to design XDog."

Early Boston Dynamics prototypes—with names like BigDog and WildCat —had gasoline engines and hydraulic actuators. This made them too large, noisy, and polluting for practical use.

In that 2016 interview, Wang said that his goal was to "make quadruped robots simpler and smaller, so that they can help ordinary people with things like carrying objects or as companions."

Boston Dynamics officially unveiled an electric quadruped called Spot in June 2016. But Spot didn't become commercially available until 2020.

That created an opening for Unitree, which Wang founded in May 2016. The company's first quadruped products— Laikago in 2017 and AlienGo in 2019—were powered by electric motors. Designed for research labs, they cost tens of thousands of dollars.

In 2021, Unitree launched the Go1 line , which started at \$2,700 for the “Air” model. In 2023, Unitree unveiled the Go2 , which was even cheaper—\$1,600 for the Air and \$2,800 for the more capable Pro.

Today, Unitree's cheapest robot—the Go2 Air—is more than 97 percent cheaper than Spot. But this is not an apples-to-apples comparison; Spot is larger than Unitree's Go2 line and can carry heavier payloads.

Still, the fact remains that Unitree made quadruped robots affordable to many people who could never afford Spot—including me! My wife never would have let me spend \$75,000 or even \$15,000 on a robot dog. But I convinced her to let me spend \$4,017 (after tariffs and shipping costs) on a Go2 Pro.

Why are Unitree robots so cheap?

Last year, the firm Simplexity tore a Go2 robot dog apart and made a video showing what they found.

Each of the robot's four legs is powered by three motors. There's a motor in the shoulder that controls the angle of the legs and a motor driving each of the two leg segments. “With three motors, you get a really dynamic range of motion,” said Luis Elenes, a mechanical engineer at Simplexity.

“They use all the same motors throughout,” Elenes added. “All four shoulders are identical in arrangement. There's tons of benefit to that. There's reduced cost, there's reduced part count. The more you can reuse motors and reuse parts, the simpler your design gets, and the more robust overall your design will be.”

Jakub Bartoszek , an expert on motors and legged robots at the startup MAB Robotics , argues that Unitree also saved money by using low-quality components. The motors in Unitree robots—many of which are made in-house—tend to wear out more quickly than those in some other robot brands, he told me. But the cost savings make the robots affordable to more people.

Unitree seems to have designed its robots for easy repairs when they wear out.

“They want these legs to be serviceable in the field,” Elenes said. Thanks to the simple way the robot's legs are attached to its body, “you can swap out a leg pretty easily. I would guess it would take you less than a minute.”

Unitree also gets significant support from the Chinese government, including tax credits and large-scale purchases by public institutions. It's hard to quantify the scale of this support because the Chinese system blurs the line between public and private, military and civilian. But a supportive policy environment clearly helped Unitree to scale up its manufacturing operations and thereby drive down the cost of each robot.

How powerful motors enable cheap actuators

Unitree has another counterintuitive cost-saving strategy: using large and powerful motors. More powerful motors aren't inherently cheaper, of course. But they allow Unitree to save money on another component called the reducer that can be even more expensive

Suppose you have a lever where one side is five times longer than the other. If you push the long side down by five inches, the short side goes up by just one inch. But force is magnified: 10 pounds on the long side becomes 50 pounds on the short side.

Many robots use gear systems called reducers that serve the same function; they convert the fast, relatively weak movement of an electric motor into a slower but stronger movement of a robot's body parts.

Traditional industrial robots require extreme precision, so they tend to have large reduction ratios.

A page on the Boston Dynamics website, for example, indicates that two of the motors in Spot's legs are paired with reducers that have gear ratios of 51 to 1. In other words, the motor would need to do 51 full rotations in order to produce one full rotation of a leg joint.

This enables Spot's movements to be very precise while magnifying the power of Spot's motors. But it also has some disadvantages. One is cost. Reducers with 51:1 ratios are complex and—as a result—tend to be significantly more expensive than reducers with lower ratios.

Another is rigidity. When a robot's arm encounters physical resistance, it should yield gracefully—a property called backdriveability. It's also helpful if a robot can sense this kind of physical resistance electrically. Robots with higher gear ratios perform badly on both these fronts; their limbs feel stiffer and they are less sensitive to physical resistance.

In contrast, Unitree uses large motors combined with a simple 6.33-to-1 gearbox. This makes its robots more nimble and dynamic while reducing costs. The simpler design is also easier to simulate, making Unitree robots easier to train.

Unitree's decision to use a lower gear ratio is part of an industry-wide trend. High gear ratios made sense for industrial robots that were programmed to perform simple, repetitive motions. In contrast, many modern robots perform complex actions in unpredictable environments. This requires sophisticated control software that can respond flexibly to changing conditions. The software is constantly making small corrections anyway, so it can compensate for less precise hardware.

One of the most impressive and crowd-pleasing capabilities of my Go2 Pro robot dog is handstands. The robot can balance on either its front or hind legs indefinitely, and can even move forward, backward, or side to side while doing so.

So it was natural for Unitree to expand into humanoids. Unitree first debuted a humanoid called the H1 in 2023. The next year, Unitree unveiled a cheaper and more capable robot called the G1.

I got to see one when I visited Xiao's lab in June. He paid around \$50,000 for a research-grade EDU version. The consumer version starts at \$13,500. This is shockingly cheap given the robot's capabilities.

A humanoid robot is more than a quadruped standing on its hind legs. My Go2 quadruped robot has three motors per leg, for a total of 12. The cheapest G1 humanoid has five motors in each arm, six in each leg, and one in the torso, for a total of 23. The leg motors in a humanoid robot also need to be more powerful, since it's more work to balance on two legs than to stand on four.

Still, I suspect that Unitree's experience with quadrupeds gave it a leg up on humanoids. By the early 2020s, Unitree had been shipping quadruped robots for several years. The company had deep expertise in actuator design and an extensive network of suppliers.

According to filings connected to Unitree's August stock offering, the company's quadruped revenue tripled between 2024 and 2025—from RMB 230 million (\$34 million) to RMB 697 million (\$104 million). The comparable figures for Unitree's humanoids were RMB 107 million (\$16 million) and RMB 867 million (\$129 million)—an eightfold increase.

Humanoids accounted for 51 percent of Unitree's revenue in 2025. I expect this figure to be even higher for 2026.

Unitree could have a durable advantage

"We are witnessing the birth of another Chinese hardware giant," wrote a team at SemiAnalysis in June. "Three years ago, Unitree was a quadruped company. By last year, they parlayed quadruped dominance into creating and leading the humanoid market."

The SemiAnalysis authors draw a parallel to DJI, the Chinese company that dominates the global drone market.

"DJI's Phantom 1 shipped January 2013 at \$679, and was not a fully-fledged product at the time," the SemiAnalysis team writes. "It had no built-in camera, no gimbal (stabilizer), ten minutes of flight, no live video feed, but it was roughly half the cost of the build-it-yourself drone."

Like DJI in 2013, Unitree's robots today have a lot of rough edges. Certainly mine does.

The app to control the robot is buggy. Features Unitree showcased in its launch video —like climbing stairs and following a human owner—don't work well in real life. If I turn the robot on with its legs slightly out of place, they will often thrash around wildly and the robot will wind up on its back.

Then there was the time my robot collapsed just feet from my house. A more polished product might have detected the low battery (or high temperature) and shut itself down gracefully.

But for bleeding-edge technologies, this kind of polish may not be very important. Far more important is getting costs down.

"DJI chose to inhouse the most expensive and technically difficult component first: the flight controller," SemiAnalysis writes. "Later on, DJI brought inhouse the gimbals, motors, and ESCs."

DJI figured out how to make these components more cheaply than they could be purchased from external suppliers, which in turn allowed it to undercut other drone makers. And that expanded the market for DJI's drones.

Before DJI came along, "professional aerial photography was the domain of helicopters and Hollywood second-unit teams, but now, small businesses could perform this on their own. As such, whole new markets were unlocked for DJI, like real estate listings, wedding videos, local news, agricultural surveying."

There's a flywheel here: The more units a company sells, the better deals it can negotiate with suppliers and the more money it can spend optimizing its manufacturing process. Larger sales volumes also allow a company to bring more components in-house. This allows the company to push costs even lower, which will mean more sales and even more money to invest in improving the production process.

Over a few years, this flywheel helped DJI to dominate the global drone market. SemiAnalysis argues that Unitree is on track to do the same thing for legged robots.

According to SemiAnalysis, Unitree has developed its own motors, gearboxes, lidar sensors, and cameras. "Unitree's self-produced motors can run as low as 30-40% of equivalent Western motors,"

SemiAnalysis reports. “They now make some of the cheapest humanoid gearboxes in the world.”

This could enable Unitree to take over the global market for quadruped and humanoid robots in much the same way that DJI took over the global drone market.

Of course that’s not guaranteed to happen. Unitree has a number of Chinese rivals. Unitree is the global leader in quadrupeds, but a Chinese rival, AgiBot, has sold more humanoid robots than Unitree in recent months. There are also many smaller robot companies in China that could challenge Unitree and AgiBot in the coming years.

But Unitree does not face much competition in the United States or the West more generally. Boston Dynamics sells excellent robots, but they tend to be significantly more expensive. There are a number of American startups aiming to build humanoid robots, including Tesla, Figure, and 1X, but consumers cannot buy a robot from any of these companies today.

That has alarmed some American policymakers. In June, a bipartisan group in the House introduced a bill to restrict importation of Chinese robots. The official press release for the legislation mentioned Unitree by name. Then in July, the FCC imposed broad new regulations on foreign-made robots that are likely to impact Unitree and other Chinese companies.

However, the robot market is global. Even if Chinese companies get locked out of the US market, Unitree or one of its Chinese rivals could still come to dominate the global market for humanoid robots.

There’s an obvious parallel here to electric vehicles, where Chinese companies like BYD are effectively banned from the US but are making rapid gains in the rest of the world. There’s a risk that a ban on Chinese robots could have a similar impact: rather than hampering the growth of companies like Unitree, it could make the US a robotics backwater.

Tim Lee was on staff at Ars from 2017 to 2021. He recently launched a new newsletter, Understanding AI . It explores how AI works and how it’s changing our world. You can subscribe to his newsletter here .

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Delta Is Getting A Huge iPhone Duo Update For Nintendo DS Emulation

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If you've ever emulated on an iPhone or an iPad, it's very likely that you have come across Delta ; it's one of the most popular emulator applications on iOS and is renowned for great user experience, reliable emulation performance and detailed customisations, even going as far as allowing you to change and add your own skins. It's one I have been using for years, and we even had Riley, the Lead Developer, on our Podcast many moons ago to talk about it.

You may have also seen that Apple has revealed their all new foldable smartphone called the iPhone Duo, and as soon as I saw it I immediately wondered how great Nintendo DS emulation would be on this thing, so I had to email my boy Riley for some confirmation, or at least a tease that he is indeed working on something for this, and to my delight, he confirmed.

"Yes, the plan is to have dedicated support for the Duo in Delta (though we're not officially announcing an exact launch date quite yet) — we actually spent a lot of time making sure that Delta worked with resizing and multi-window support back when Stage Manager first debuted for iPadOS, and fortunately that work has proven very applicable here" , states Riley, the Lead Developer.

That's all Riley could share with me at this moment in time, though Delta did share the image above on their Threads page , showing that indeed, a big update is coming to please many Nintendo DS fans looking for a unique, modern and easy way to play their favourite games on the go, on a folding smartphone. I'm already excited to see all of the crazy skins that gamers create for this screen real estate.

With the increase in popularity of Nintendo DS emulation this year in the form of the ANBERNIG RG DS Plus , the Retroid Pocket Duo and the Yoniq Duo, it's good to see yet another way to explore this handheld's library of incredible games and no doubt the team at Delta is going to make this a fun and

silky smooth way to do just that in update 2.0.

Riley couldn't mention a release date, but their promotional image suggests it could be in line with the Duo's launch in October, and a lot of the work is already done from previous iPad developments, making me believe this could be true. Only time will tell, but it's clear myself and many are excited to hear that this is in development. I am still unsure if I can afford to snag an iPhone Duo, but you'll know if I do, as I'll do a deep dive into Delta on iPhone Duo. Be sure to join our free weekly newsletter to not miss out on that!

ANBERNIC RG DS Plus Price & Release Date Announced

The GAMEMT MTX Handheld That Takes GBA Cartridges Is In The Wild

Pokémon Wild Indigo Sees Gamers Playing As A Space Trucker On A Mysterious Planet

Retroid Announces Pre-Order Date Of Pocket Duo Dual-Screen Handhelds

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Some satellite companies still have an appetite for boutique launch services

"Dedicated launch is pretty essential for us for most of our missions."



If you ask most satellite companies aside from SpaceX, they will tell you the world doesn't have enough capacity for launching payloads into orbit. This is despite the blistering launch cadence we've seen around the world in recent years, led by SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket.

Customers in any sector will, of course, usually welcome competition. Theoretically, competition will lead to lower prices and allow the best to rise to the top. It seems like the customers buying launch services were right. SpaceX is dialing back its Falcon 9 launch program, and there is no certainty about when SpaceX's reusable next-generation super-heavy-lift rocket, Starship, will carry anything to orbit besides the company's own Starlink satellites.

So it's no surprise satellite operators are cheering the success of a new launch provider. This was especially the case a few days ago, when Germany's Isar Aerospace reached orbit for the first time with its Spectrum rocket. The launcher delivered a batch of CubeSats to low-Earth orbit from a spaceport in northern Norway, and Isar tasted success after its first test flight ended in failure last year.

Isar's success is good news for Europe's space sector, eager for a new path to orbit alongside the continent's incumbent launch providers, Arianespace and Avio. Several European companies are running to catch up with Isar, including another German startup, Rocket Factory Augsburg, and Spain's PLD Space. The Exploration Company, based in Germany and France, is working on a heavy-lift-class rocket engine.

Halfway around the world from Europe, executives at the Japanese-headquartered satellite company Astroscale were awake at 5 am local time on Sunday to watch the live webcast from Norway as Isar aimed for the stars. Just days earlier, Astroscale announced it had signed a deal with Isar to launch a mission as soon as next year.

This was the second launch contract Astroscale has inked with Isar. The companies announced a contract in March for the Spectrum rocket to launch a different Astroscale satellite. Astroscale signed these agreements with Isar before the company achieved orbit.

Astroscale wasn't alone in placing early bets on Isar. Government-backed missions from the European Space Agency, the European Union, and the Norwegian and German governments make up the bulk of the company's launch backlog. Those customers have an interest in helping Isar gain a foothold in the launch market.

But Isar Aerospace could not count Astroscale as part of its captive market, so it was noteworthy that an established company selected an unproven rocket to launch two of its most important missions. Astroscale's business is focused on satellite servicing and mitigation of space junk, a segment of the market that matches well with rockets the size of Isar's Spectrum for dedicated rides to orbit.

Another satellite servicing company, US-based Katalyst Space, launched a spacecraft in July in pursuit of a NASA astronomy satellite falling out of orbit. Like Astroscale, Katalyst required a dedicated launch into a unique orbit to reach its target. It chose the seldom-used air-launched Pegasus XL rocket made by Northrop Grumman. Technical problems prevented Katalyst from rescuing NASA's aging Swift observatory.

One of Astroscale's missions assigned to launch with Isar Aerospace is ELSA-M, led by Astroscale's UK division. The ELSA-M spacecraft will capture and deorbit a satellite in Eutelsat's OneWeb broadband constellation to demonstrate end-of-life servicing. The other is ADRAS-J2, a demonstration mission partially funded by the Japanese space agency that will attempt to grab onto a defunct Japanese rocket in space and remove it from orbit. ADRAS-J2 follows a highly successful demo mission called ADRAS-J that approached and inspected the same Japanese rocket body in 2024.

Both missions are key to proving out Astroscale's capabilities for what it sees as lucrative business opportunities in the satellite servicing market. Ars spoke with Chris Blackerby, Astroscale's chief operating officer, this week to discuss the company's goals in satellite servicing and its appetite for launch services. We present a portion of the interview below.

Ars Technica: You must have been thrilled with the results from Isar's test flight. What was it like seeing the rocket reach orbit?

Chris Blackerby: It was Sunday morning, 5 am or so Japan time, and I was up watching. They did a fantastic job in everything from the PR side of it, having the chief engineer on there to explain everything. Even just watching them explain through as I was sitting on my couch early in the morning on Sunday, my confidence was growing as I was watching the team explain everything they'd done, all the prep they had taken to get to that point. We'd done a lot of background research. We had teams go out there to do due diligence research at their manufacturing site and talk to a lot of their technical leaders. So we were pretty confident already. Certainly, the launch was incredible. Checking off all the markers, all the milestones, deploying the payloads—it was everything we could have hoped for. Obviously, congratulations to them. But yeah, you're right. We have two big missions set up on Isar, and we're excited to see them continue to improve and show success and get to launch with them.

Ars: Astroscale's business case seems to require dedicated launches. Rideshare doesn't really work if you're trying to launch into a very specific orbit and reach a specific satellite for servicing. Is that correct? Why not go for a launch on a proven rocket, like Rocket Lab's Electron, which you used for your previous mission?

Blackerby: Launch, as you well know, is the big issue around the industry writ large. First of all, to answer the specific question, yeah, you're right, dedicated launch is pretty essential for us for most of

our missions. We could do a rideshare, but it's much more complicated. So a dedicated launch makes it much better. Then we have to factor in capacity for the payload, and that can answer your second question. Right now, for Rocket Lab current capability, we've expanded beyond it. ADRAS-J was smaller, mass-wise, so it could fit into an Electron. ADRAS-J2 and ELSA-M cannot. Of course, they could fit into (Rocket Lab's) Neutron, but they're not ready yet.

And when we look around at other options, Stephen, for all of the talk about the ubiquity of launch and the dropping prices and the capacity that's everywhere, I don't know. I don't see it yet. There are not a lot of consistently reliable options that are out there. I don't think that's anything that's too controversial to say. So we had to look for something that fit our budget. It had to fit our capacity in terms of size. It should be dedicated, as you mentioned. So when you get that Venn diagram that throws in all of those various requirements, Isar really fit the bill. And yes, choosing a launch provider that hasn't proven consistent success yet is definitely a risk. But as I said, we did a lot of checking on them, a lot of due diligence, and we're very confident what we what we decided.

Ars: The only other proven launch provider in that 1-ton range is Firefly Aerospace, but they've had some issues with their Alpha rocket.

Blackerby: That's exactly right. Our missions are around that area, under a ton, but in the 500 to 700 kilogram area. And yeah, there's not much. There were a bunch that were out there that were in that area for a while, including Relativity, they were aiming for that, and Astra was in that. There were a few others that were in that range at one time. But everybody is going bigger now, so there's not a lot. There are still a few small ones out there, but to fit into that dedicated 1-ton class, there's not a lot. We're hopeful. We're thinking about launch vehicles, which we all have to be thinking about, especially with all of the SpaceX news recently, and the uncertainties that have been widely reported about how available rideshares are going to be with SpaceX. We're just excited to see proof from a lot of different operators. Blue Origin, we saw the big Stoke fundraiser recently, so yeah, we'll see. But you're right. As far as 500-kilogram to 1-ton class, there are not a lot of options.

Ars: The ADRAS-J mission appeared to be a huge success for Astroscale. What did you learn, and how did that prepare you for going up to grab that rocket?

Blackerby: It was such an incredible mission. I love talking about it. It was pretty ground-breaking. We are extremely excited and extremely grateful to JAXA (the Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency) for driving this, and this is the first step toward proving out an on-orbit servicing capability toward more sustainable use of space and debris removal, which was the foundation of Astroscale. But beyond that, the capabilities to identify, approach, rendezvous with an object in orbit, which is fairly unprecedented from a commercial company, especially a non-communicative one like the ADRAS-J client was, as it will be again for ADRAS-J2.

In terms of what we learned, boy, we need a whole conversation on this. But just building out a mission that needed to approach an unprepared, uncommunicative object, everything that goes into that from the hardware side, from the ConOps (concept of operations) development, making sure that we make it as safe as possible, so that there is fault identification analysis to say, 'OK, detect the problem, make sure that the spacecraft knows that when it's autonomously approaching, as it gets close, it can identify where there's any kind of anomaly, and it knows we need to try again. Safety is the paramount issue when we're doing anything like this, approaching an object in orbit. That was key, and all of those learnings from designing, building, manufacturing, launching, operating the satellite. It was everything. We learned so much from that.

The pictures, which you've seen, the images that we took from ADRAS-J are so exquisite, and it helped us to build ADRAS-J2. We now know what the client object looks like. We know it's not rotating. That

was a key step. We built ADRAS-J to be able to rotate around the client object in orbit, so that if we had to find that payload adapter as we're spinning around, we could go in and grab it for ADRAS-J2. What we learned with ADRAS-J is the client object is pretty stably pointing down toward the Earth. We got a very clear image of what the object looks like right now. We know it's not degraded. We know that there's a clear path toward grabbing it at the payload adapter. All of those are things that we learned over the development of ADRAS-J that have helped building ADRAS-J2, I won't say easier because none of this is easy, but easier than it would have been without that kind of capability and that kind of knowledge.

Ars: You have another mission working with JAXA, ISSA-J1, to go rendezvous and inspect two decommissioned Japanese satellites. How is that different than inspecting a rocket body?

Blackerby: ADRAS-J2 is going to an oblong rocket body. It's not spinning. ISSA-J1 is going to satellites, and it's going to have to approach something that has a solar array sticking out, so we're expecting that it could be spinning. So the RPO (rendezvous and proximity operations) is definitely going to be more complex. We need to be able to develop this tech to precisely approach this large piece of debris that likely is not going to be a stable object, and we're also going to a couple of them with ISSA-J1. A lot of the technical capabilities that we've developed by building out all of our missions... they share a common baseline in terms of technology as we think about the guidance, navigation and control, and the visualization and the RPO that's necessary to do this identification and approach. But there are all these little differences, and that's why each mission is unique in its own way, and it all builds to this larger dataset of learnings that we're developing, and all of this is in pursuit of this servicing ecosystem. If we're going to get to this level of servicing ecosystem for all aspects of security and economics and the sustainability of the space environment, we need to have this large dataset of approaching objects, of identifying objects, and of capturing objects, and so that's what we're building out across the board in the portfolio of our missions.

Ars: So you're crawling before walking or running?

Blackerby: That's it. Our first mission, ELSA-D, that was definitely a crawl. In that case, we brought our debris with us, and let that go, and then showed we could capture it. That was the first step.

Ars: What is the operational use case for the technology Astroscale is developing?

Blackerby: I'm assuming you mean like repeatable, consistent servicing. Every step we take is another step toward that goal. It's hard for us to give a specific date on that or a timeframe. But the fact is, we've got eight, nine missions under manufacturing right now around the world. We have a variety already that are out there. None of them are on the level of, say, a repeatable multi-order service yet. That's going to come. It's just a matter of time. The missions that we're doing now, we've taken these incremental steps. ELSA-D, our first mission, was fully internally funded. That was funded by the money that we raised on the equity markets. ADRAS-J, the second mission, that was that was jointly funded with JAXA, so we worked on that together. ELSA-M, we're working on that together with ESA and the UK Space Agency. With ADRAS-J2, we're getting toward being revenue-positive with these missions. Our missions going forward, for the most part, are revenue-positive. If we look at that from the perspective of sustainability, not of space, but of our company, economic financial sustainability, we're already getting to that point. We need to get more toward a commercially repeatable mission, and we're not there yet. But we'd like to see, by the early part of the next decade, the early 2030s, that we're going to start seeing a more consistent, commercially viable servicing ecosystem being developed.

Ars: You have a refueling demonstration mission, the Provisioner, under contract with the US Space Force. What business opportunities do you see coming from the US military?

Blackerby: Provisioner is big. We're really excited about that. That's launching soon as well, and it's going to demonstrate the capability of refueling. We think there's going to be a growing market for that, and the demand signal is coming in from the US. When we think about where that next technology and demand is going to be, refueling is a big one. You've seen what some of the other contracts are that are out there. There's a deorbit-as-a-service study that's been put out (by the Defense Innovation Unit). There are some life extension mission interests that we see. We see a lot coming out in terms of close-in inspection, making sure that the customer can understand where the threats are, and whether that's debris or some other kind of threat, they want to be able to have the capability to do close-in RPO. So we're excited for all of these kinds of missions that governments are showing an interest in that require a close-in RPO.

To be clear, we're talking about the capability to identify and station-keep and come in close to an object. This is not about flying by an object and snapping pictures as you go, or getting to within a couple kilometers and taking pictures. We got to within meters of ADRAS-J. That's the kind of really incredibly exquisite capability that we're building out. We see that there's going to be interest in docking, taking pictures, all of that. We're seeing interest from not just the US government, but from governments and even the commercial sector across all of the regions where we're located globally.

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‘Please,’ ‘God Is Shy,’ ‘Ball Face’ Among 2026 Viborg Animation Festival Winners

VAF handed out awards for its 2026 competition on Friday evening in the quaint Danish city, where Anna Mantzaris' 'Please' emerged as the event's big winner.



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VIBORG, DENMARK – Viborg Animation Festival (VAF) handed out awards for its 2026 competition on Friday evening in the quaint Danish city, where Anna Mantzaris' *Please* emerged as the event's big winner. The stop-motion dark comedy took both the Audience Award and the Zeitgeist Award, giving Mantzaris recognition from festivalgoers as well as VAF's jury.

Held September 7–13, VAF combines international screenings with talks, workshops, exhibitions, pitchings, and more experimental events that highlight Denmark's animation and games industries. The festival has particularly close ties, organizationally and geographically, to Viborg's The Animation Workshop, one of Europe's leading animation schools, and its awards reflect that dual focus on established international filmmakers and emerging local talent.

Several of this year's winning films arrived on festival hot-streaks. Laurence Thérien's *Ball Face*, a darkly comic claymation film about a schoolgirl attempting to survive a brutal ball game, won VAF's graduation prize after taking the graduation film *Cristal* at Annecy in June. The film uses its protagonist's continually deforming face to explore resilience, masking, and the ways children reshape themselves to fit in.

VAF's best short prize went to Jocelyn Charles' *God Is Shy*. The French film follows two train passengers who pass the time by drawing their greatest fears before a mysterious older woman joins their game. It previously screened in competition at Cannes' Critics' Week, earned a César nomination, and won the Labo competition's grand prize at Clermont-Ferrand.

Nicolas Piret's *Venezia Diorama* was named best experimental film, while Mike A. Smith's hand-drawn *The Epic of Enkidu* received the Children's Choice Award. Smith's film offers a fractured, comic retelling

of the ancient Epic of Gilgamesh , shifting the story's attention to the wild man Enkidu and imagining what might have been lost from the surviving clay tablets.

The festival also recognized a Danish short and a student-developed game. Nothing Really Dies received the FVV Danish Talent Award, while the wonderfully titled The Religious Quest of Saint Kjeld & His Slightly Questionable Use of Coffins won the VAF Talent Jam.

Audience Award Please , Anna Mantzaris (Sweden, France, Czech Republic, Norway, Finland)

FVV Danish Talent Award Nothing Will Die, Rasmus Sølvsten (Denmark)

Best Graduation Film Ball Face , Laurence Thérien (U.K., Canada)

Best Experimental Film Venezia Diorama , Nicolas Piret (Belgium)

Best Short Film God Is Shy , Jocelyn Charles (France)

Children's Choice Award The Epic of Enkidu , Mike A. Smith (U.S.)

Zeitgeist Award Please , Anna Mantzaris (Sweden, France, Czech Republic, Norway, Finland)

VAF Talent Jam The Religious Quest of Saint Kjeld & His Slightly Questionable Use of Coffins

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Why Xbox's New Disc Feature Matters to the Generation That Grew Up With Cartridges

Anyone who grew up with an NES, Mega Drive, SNES or early PlayStation probably remembers what owning a game looked like. It had a box, a cartridge or disc, sometimes a thick manual and a permanent place on a shelf. You could lend it to... The post [Why Xbox's New Disc Feature Matters to the Generation That Grew Up With Cartridges](#) first appeared on Retromash .



Why Xbox's New Disc Feature Matters to the Generation That Grew Up With Cartridges

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Anyone who grew up with an NES, Mega Drive, SNES or early PlayStation probably remembers what owning a game looked like. It had a box, a cartridge or disc, sometimes a thick manual and a permanent place on a shelf. You could lend it to a friend, trade it in or pull it out years later and try it again.

That idea of ownership has changed. Digital libraries are convenient, yet they also depend on accounts, storefronts and platform support. Xbox's latest disc-to-digital test has reopened an old question in a very modern form: what does it actually mean to own a game?

How Entertainment Moved From Ownership to Online Access For players raised in the eighties and nineties, a game was usually something they physically possessed. Even as consoles became more advanced, the relationship remained simple. If the cartridge or disc still worked and the hardware could read it, the game was yours to play. Access did not rely on an active account or a rotating digital catalogue.

That permanence contrasts sharply with how modern leisure industries operate today. Across the board, core products have undergone complete digitisation. Music moved from CDs to streaming platforms, films left the physical shelf for subscription libraries, and traditional venue-based betting shifted to digital hubs where operators like NetBet consolidate their game libraries and player promotions within a single account ecosystem.

This shift to digital brings undeniable convenience. You can log in, access a huge catalogue of content, and manage your profile instantly. However, it also alters the fundamental nature of access. A boxed game takes up space and requires working hardware, yet it offers a degree of independence that an entirely account-reliant service simply cannot replicate.

Xbox Is Trying to Give Discs a Digital Second Life Xbox announced on 26 August 2026 that Insiders would begin testing a feature allowing supported Xbox One and Xbox Series X discs to unlock a digital entitlement. The original disc continues to work, while the entitlement can add access to features such as Xbox Play Anywhere and cloud gaming where supported.

The idea stands out because it tries to keep the disc useful while adding some of the flexibility players now associate with digital libraries. Xbox has also framed the feature as part of its broader approach to preservation.

For anyone who remembers swapping cartridges at school or buying second-hand games from a local shop, the appeal is easy to understand. The object itself has not been made irrelevant. Access still relies partly on Xbox infrastructure, though, so the disc does not become a completely platform-independent archive.

PlayStation Is Moving Further Away From Physical Releases Sony is heading in a different direction. It confirmed in July 2026 that disc production for new PlayStation releases will end from January 2028. Games released before that date are not affected, while new titles after the cutoff will move to digital formats.

That shift changes the collecting side of gaming as much as the buying process. Boxed games can be resold, lent, displayed and collected. Packaging and manuals also became part of the identity of many older releases, especially in the cartridge and early-disc eras. Original boxes and printed material can matter almost as much as the software itself, which is why complete examples remain such a big part of retro gaming collections. A digital-only future removes much of that ritual. Buying becomes faster, but there is less to pass on, trade or discover years later in a second-hand shop.

Old Games Show Why Physical Copies Still Matter Older games already show what can happen when commercial access disappears. A Video Game History Foundation study found that only about 13% of classic games released in the United States between 1960 and 2009 remained commercially available. Its study of classic game availability shows how quickly titles can vanish once publishers, storefronts or hardware move on.

For some games, an aging cartridge or disc and a working console may still be the most straightforward legitimate way to play. Original hardware can matter too. Controllers, display technology, loading behaviour and small technical quirks can all change how an old game feels compared with a modern rerelease.

Old media has its own weaknesses. Discs scratch, batteries fail and aging consoles need repairs. Collectors still have something tangible to maintain, though, rather than relying entirely on continued access to a digital service.

Physical and Digital Ownership Now Serve Different Purposes Digital gaming has obvious advantages. Buying a game takes minutes, storage is simpler and a library can travel with an account across supported devices. For plenty of players, that convenience matters more than having another case on a shelf. A boxed copy serves a different purpose. It supports collecting, lending and resale, and it can keep older games accessible after their original commercial moment has passed. That difference is especially noticeable to people who grew up when every game had to be brought home.

Xbox's latest experiment sits somewhere between those two habits. The disc remains part of the experience, while the digital entitlement adds the sort of convenience modern players have come to expect. For anyone who grew up blowing dust from a cartridge or carrying a stack of discs to a friend's house, that distinction still means something.

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Retroid Pocket Duo & Duo Lite Full Specifications Finally Revealed

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It was only this morning when I finished writing a new post about the Retroid Pocket Duo's pricing , and then, just a few hours later, the full list of specifications for both the Pocket Duo and Pocket Duo Lite was revealed, their two new upcoming dual-screen handhelds.

Firstly, I like that they're making two variants of the device, offering choice to those with different budgets, and it also allows Retroid to own more of the dual-screen market when you consider that their parent company also make the AYN Thor.

The Duo Lite is an interesting device for sure, one competitively priced and, as you can see from the specifications below, doesn't feature all the bells and whistles, but might get you up to 3DS and GameCube emulation, but we won't know until we get one in to review. The same goes for the Duo; it'll likely emulate PlayStation 2 games. Below is a list of the full specs, revealed by Retro Gaming Consoles on X.

Retroid Pocket Duo Lite Specifications

Retroid Pocket Duo Specifications

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